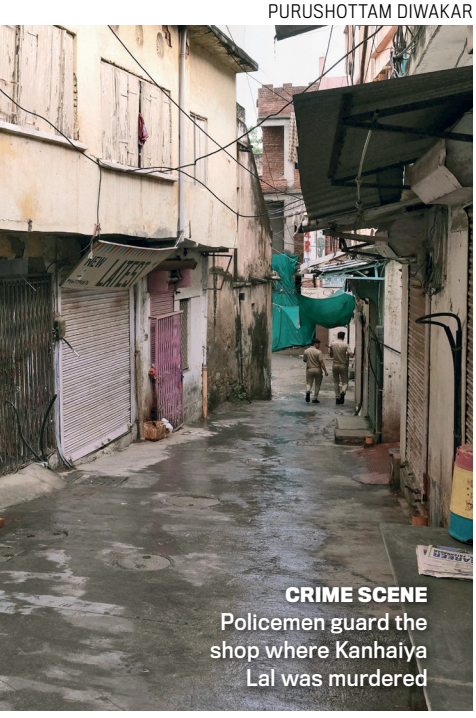


PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR



CRIME SCENE Policemen guard the shop where Kanhaiya Lal was murdered

UNANSWERED QUESTIONS

1. Gaus had visited Pakistan for 45 days in 2014, why wasn't he red-flagged by the intelligence agencies?
2. Why was Riyaz attending BJP events in Rajasthan; was he part of their minority cell?
3. Who paid for the foreign trips of Gaus and Riyaz?
4. Was the Pakistani ISI involved in grooming Gaus as a mole in india?
5. Did Gaus and Riyaz act on their own or were more locals involved in planning the murder?

and its affiliate organisations as part of its so-called 'minority cell'.

The Rajasthan Congress has accused the opposition BJP of cultivating such people and then brainwashing them to commit crimes so as to run down the Muslim community. State PCC president Govind Singh Dotasra wrote in a letter to NIA chief Dinkar Gupta on July 5: "Our countrymen are anxious about whether the BJP, in its greed for power, is supporting anti-national activities. I request you to expand the NIA's investigations to look into the BJP link in both the Udaipur and Kashmir incidents and bring out the truth." Dotasra was referring to photos of Riyaz with BJP leaders and, in the Kashmir incident, Talib Hussain Shah, an alleged Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) commander arrested on July 4 who reportedly headed the BJP's minority morcha and IT cell in Jammu at one point.

The BJP's Gulab Chand Kataria, leader of the opposition and a former home minister, has asked the police to probe whether his photograph with Riyaz in the backdrop was morphed. The police say they are yet to question Riyaz on why he had been visiting the BJP events but confirm that he used to frequent the place where Kanhaiya Lal ran his tailoring shop to meet friends, which is perhaps how he got to know about Lal's social media post. Riyaz even sharpened the cleavers used in the killing and made a video on June 17 announcing the planned murder.

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot has been quick to take credit for getting the accused arrested within hours and maintaining peace despite the charged atmosphere. Additional forces were mobilised for sensitive areas and protest marches by Hindutva groups and the BJP across the state remained mostly peaceful. The CM also visited the family of Kanhaiya Lal and also met with Ishwari Singh, Lal's helper at the tailor shop who is recuperating from the injuries he received in the horrific attack.

Gehlot also met Shakti Singh and Prahlad Singh, the two young villagers who, on being alerted by a policeman, chased the escaping Gaus and Riyaz for miles and tipped the police about their location. Amid allegations of police failure, five officers of the Rajasthan Police Services were suspended for not taking Kanhaiya Lal's pleas about a threat to his life seriously.

The BJP leaders reacted a bit late but on July 4 former chief minister Vasundhara Raje and Union minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat visited Lal's family where, predictably, they blamed the Gehlot government for the murder. Meanwhile, the state's reputation too has taken a hit with huge cancellations of tourists arrivals in Udaipur and Muslims expressing fears that they could be further isolated as Hindu employers shy away from hiring members of the community. ■